

Discipline Yourself So No One Else Has To: Introduction, Featuring Joan Cronan

Joan Cronan, Women's Athletic Director Emeritus, University of Tennessee

Pat wrote in her book, "I don't like this subject. It makes me bite my lip. I warn you right now that my warmest, friendliest side doesn't show up in these pages. By the time you're done, you'll think I'm one tough lady and you may even like me a little less. That's OK as long as you respect me and believe in what I tell you, because that's what discipline is about. It's about belief."

Coach Summitt was a master at self-discipline. From a hard upbringing on a dairy farm, discipline was a way of life for Pat. She couldn't escape it if she tried. But that early work ethic made an incredible mark on Pat's life and her willingness to discipline in everything she did, including following her dreams. Pat's passion and genius was in learning all she could about each of her players. What inspired them? What built them and brought out the best in them?

But when it came to discipline, Coach Summitt was steadfast. Discipline needed to be the same for everyone. She was an equal opportunity disciplinarian. In this module, we will dive into the topic of self-discipline. After all, as Pat said often, you "discipline yourself before someone else has to." We will learn from Pat's leadership wisdom that discipline must be fair, firm, and consistent.

Pat often said ...

Coach Pat Summitt

"Discipline fosters achievement and self-confidence. Discipline is the only sure way I know to convince people to believe in themselves. Discipline gets you out of bed in the morning. It gets you to work on time and it tells you when you need to work late. It drives you. It's essential to success, whether individually or in a group."

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Discipline is the internal mechanism that self-motivates you. Are you your own self-disciplinarian? Although it is difficult and not fun, when we discipline ourselves, we clear the path for realizing our goal.

Let's learn from Pat how to discipline ourselves where no one else has to.